

Editor/Debugger Settings

You can customize the visual display and functionality of the Editor, Live Editor, and Debugger using Editor/Debugger settings.

General Settings for the Editor/Debugger

You can specify which editor MATLAB® uses, as well as how the MATLAB Editor and Live Editor behave under various circumstances.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger**, and then adjust setting options as described in this table.

Setting	Usage
Live script format	Specify the default file format for creating live scripts using the Default live script file format setting. - Select MLX to create new live scripts as live code files with a <code>.mlx</code> extension by default. - Select M to create new live scripts as plain text live code files with a <code>.m</code> extension by default.
End of line sequence	Specify the default end of line sequence when creating new files using the Default end of line sequence setting. - Select LF - Linux or macOS to use the line feed character (<code>\n</code>). - Select CRLF to use the carriage return and line feed characters (<code>\r\n</code>). (since R2026a)
Editor	Select which editor you want the MATLAB desktop to use when you edit a file: MATLAB Editor Text editor If you select Text editor, specify the full path for the editor application you want to use, such as Emacs or vi. For example, <code>c:/Applications/Emacs.exe</code>. This setting applies only to plain text files such as MATLAB Code files (<code>.m</code>) and files with a <code>.txt</code> extension and is not supported in MATLAB Online™.
Most recently used file list	In the Number of entries field, type the number of files that you want to appear in the list of recently used files at the bottom of the File menu.

Setting	Usage
Opening files in Editor	Select On restart reopen files from previous MATLAB session if you want files open during your last MATLAB session to reopen when you restart MATLAB.
	Select Automatically open files when MATLAB reaches a breakpoint to open a running program file when MATLAB encounters a breakpoint in that file.
	Select Display full path of files in the Editor to display the full path of files open in the Editor and Live Editor. The path displays at the top of each open file.
Automatic file changes	Select Reload unedited files that have been externally modified if you want the Editor to automatically reload the version of a file that you opened and edited outside of MATLAB when the file currently open in the Editor has no unsaved changes.
	Select Add line termination at end of file to have MATLAB add a new empty line (sometimes referred to as a <CR>) to the end of a file automatically if the last line in the file is not empty. This setting applies only to plain text files such as files with a .m or .txt extension.
Debugging	Specify when to show the inline Step in button using the Show inline Step In buttons setting. - Select Always to show the button for all functions and scripts. - Select For user-defined functions to show the button only for user-defined functions and scripts. - Select Never to never show the button.
	Select Open Debugger panel automatically to open the Debugger panel automatically when MATLAB enters debug mode. Clear Open Debugger panel automatically to disable opening the Debugger panel automatically.

Editor/Debugger Autocoding Settings

You can change whether MATLAB automatically completes block endings, parentheses, quotes, comments, character vectors, and strings in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Autocoding**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

*In R2025a: Autocoding settings are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Suggestions and Autocompletions**.*

*Before R2025a: Autocoding settings are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Automatic Completions**.*

Setting	Usage
Autocoding options	Select Enable autocoding to enable autocoding options in the Editor, Live Editor, and App Designer. Once enabled, options can be enabled or disabled individually.
Autocomplete pairs	Select Parentheses () to autocomplete parentheses.
	Select Curly braces { } to autocomplete curly braces.
	Select Square brackets [] to autocomplete square brackets.
	Select Single quotes (') to autocomplete single quotes.
	Select Double quotes (") to autocomplete double quotes.
Autocomplete on new line	Select Comments (%) to automatically split comments when you press Enter. For example, place your cursor after the first period in the comment below and press Enter. <pre>% This is my first comment. This is my second comment.</pre> The text after the cursor moves to a new line and the Editor adds a percent (%) symbol to the beginning of the new line. <pre>% This is my first comment. % This is my second comment.</pre>
	Select Character vectors (') to automatically split character vectors when you press Enter. For example, place your cursor after the word Random in the character vector below and press Enter. <pre>title('Mean of Random Uniform Data')</pre> The Editor splits the character vector into two character vectors across two lines. <pre>title(['Mean of Random' ... ' Uniform Data'])</pre>
	Select Strings (") to automatically split strings when you press Enter. For example, place your cursor after the word long in the string below and press Enter. <pre>exist("exceptionally_long_file_name.txt")</pre> The Editor splits the string into two strings on two lines. <pre>exist("exceptionally_long" + ... "_file_name.txt")</pre>

Setting	Usage
	Select Parentheses () to automatically split parentheses when you press Enter. For example, place your cursor after the number 10 and the comma in the command below and press Enter. <pre>plot(x,y,'--gs','LineWidth',2,'MarkerSize',10,'MarkerEdgeColor','b')</pre> The Editor splits the command onto two lines. <pre>plot(x,y,'--gs','LineWidth',2,'MarkerSize',10, ... 'MarkerEdgeColor','b')</pre>
Autocomplete block endings	Select Control flow statements (if, for, etc.) to autocomplete control flow statements. To autocomplete a statement, enter the statement and press Enter. For a list of control flow statements, see Loops and Conditional Statements.
	Select Function and class definitions to autocomplete function and class definitions. To autocomplete a definition, enter either function or class and press Enter.

Editor/Debugger Autoformatting Settings

You can quickly format live scripts and functions using autoformatting markup in the Live Editor. You can enable and disable autoformatting as a whole, or as individual options. Autoformatting settings do not apply in the Editor.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Autoformatting**, and then adjust setting options as described in this table.

For more information about autoformatting in the Live Editor, see [Autoformatting](#).

Setting	Usage
Enable autoformatting in Live Editor	Select to enable autoformatting options in the Live Editor. Once enabled, options can then be enabled or disabled individually.
Text format	Select *italic* , **bold** to enable bold and italic formatting using asterisks (*).
	Select _italic_ , __bold__ to enable bold and italic formatting using underscores (_).
	Select `monospace` , monospace to enable monospace autoformatting.
Section break	Select %% , *** , or --- for section break to enable inserting section breaks by entering %% , *** , or --- and then Enter .
	Select %% text for section break and heading to enable inserting section breaks with heading 1 style headings by entering %%text and then Enter .
Insert Options	Select \$LaTeX\$ for LaTeX equation to enable converting LaTeX expressions into equations using the format \$LaTeX\$.

Setting	Usage
	Select URL for hyperlink to enable converting internet paths automatically to hyperlinks.
	Select <URL> for hyperlink to enable converting internet paths to hyperlinks using the format <URL>.
	Select [Label](URL) for labeled hyperlink to enable converting internet paths to labeled hyperlinks using the format [Label](URL).
	Select (TM), (SM), (R), and (C) for trademark, service mark, and copyright symbols to enable inserting trademark and copyright symbols (TM , SM , ®, and ©) using the format (TM), (SM), (R), and (C).
Text Style	Select #text for title to enable inserting titles using the format #text.
	Select ##text, ###text, or ####text for heading to enable inserting headings using the format ##text for heading 1, ###text for heading 2, or ####text for heading 3.
	Select Automatic bulleted lists (*, +, or -) to enable creating bulleted lists by entering *, +, or - followed by a space.
	Select Automatic numbered lists (1., 2., etc.) to enable creating numbered lists by entering 1., 2., and so on, followed by a space.

Editor/Debugger Code Folding Settings

Code folding enables you to expand and collapse blocks of MATLAB code that you want to hide when you are not currently working on them. Code folding settings do not apply in the Live Editor.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Code Folding**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

For examples and detailed information about code folding, see [Fold Code](#).

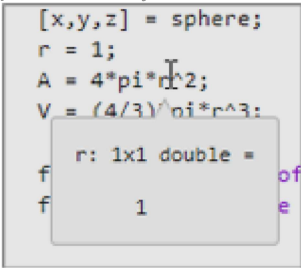
Setting	Usage
Enable code folding	Specifies whether you want code folding enabled for the programming constructs that have their corresponding Enable check box selected.
Enable	Specifies whether you want code folding enabled for the corresponding Programming Construct . If you select this option for any construct, but clear the Enable Code Folding option, the construct will not have code folding enabled.

Setting	Usage
Fold Initially	Specifies whether the corresponding Programming Construct displays collapsed (folded) the first time that you open a MATLAB file.

Editor/Debugger Display Settings

You can change the appearance of the Editor and Live Editor.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Display**, and then adjust setting options as described in this table.

Setting	Usage
General display options	Select Highlight Current Line and select a color to highlight the row with the cursor (also called the caret). This setting does not apply in the Live Editor.
	Select Show line numbers to display line numbers along the left edge of the Editor and Live Editor window.
	Select Enable data tips in edit mode to display data tips when you are editing a MATLAB code file. (Data tips are always enabled in debug mode.) 
	For more information, see View Variable Value . This setting does not apply in the Live Editor. To enable or disable data tips in the Live Editor, go to the View tab and toggle the  Datatips button on or off.
	Select Enable zooming with Ctrl+Scroll to enable changing the zoom level of the Editor and Live editor using the Ctrl+Plus and Ctrl+Minus keyboard shortcuts. On macOS, use the Command key instead of the Ctrl key.
	Select Enable zooming for individual files to enable changing the zoom level for an individual file open in the Editor or Live Editor.
	Select an option from Live Editor default view to specify the default location of output when creating new live scripts: Output on right — Output displays to the right of the code. Each output displays with the line

Setting	Usage
	that creates it. This option is ideal when writing code. To disable the alignment of output to code when output is on the right, right-click the output section and select Disable Synchronous Scrolling. • Output inline — Output displays inline with the code. Each output displays underneath the line that creates it. This option is ideal for sharing.
	Select Focus outputs using keyboard when output is inline to enable using the up arrow and down arrow keys to move focus to the output when output is inline.
	Select Show the Open as a Live Script banner if you want the Open as a Live Script banner to appear at the top of documents in the Editor.
Right-hand text limit	Select Show line to display a vertical line with the specified Color at the specified column (Placement) in the Editor. For details, see Change the Right-Side Text Limit Indicator. This setting does not apply in the Live Editor.

Editor/Debugger Find and Replace Settings

You can change the behavior of the Find and Replace dialog box, including disabling wrap-around search.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Find and Replace**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

Setting	Usage
Search behavior	Select Wrap around to continue searching from the start of the document when the end of the document is reached, until the whole document has been searched.
	Select Move cursor while typing to move the cursor to the first result while typing the search phrase. Clear Move cursor while typing to move the cursor only after the entire search phrase has been entered.
	Select Highlight search results to highlight all search results in the document.
	Select Highlight selection matches to highlight instances of text that match your selection in the document.

Setting	Usage
Search text	Select Use selection for initial search text to use the current selection as the initial search text.
	Select Use nearest word for initial search text to use the word closest to the cursor position as the initial search text.
Search history	Select Persist search and replace history across sessions to save the search and replace history and the Find and Replace dialog box state across sessions. Clear Persist search and replace history across sessions to disable saving any search and replace data, including the Find and Replace dialog box state.
Position	Select Position dialog box above document to position the Find and Replace dialog box in added space above the document when the dialog box is open. When the Find and Replace dialog box is closed, the space is removed. This added space prevents the dialog box from covering part of the document when the dialog box is open.

Editor/Debugger Indenting Settings

You can change the size of tabs and indents and the behavior of smart indenting in the Editor and Live Editor. To enable or disable smart indenting, see [Editor/Debugger MATLAB Language Settings](#) and [Editor/Debugger Other Languages Settings](#).

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Indenting**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

Option	Usage
Tabs and indents	Specify Tab size to determine the amount of space inserted when you press the Tab key.
	When you change the Tab size value, the tab size changes for existing lines in that file, unless you also select Tab key inserts spaces .
	Specify Indent size for smart indenting.
	Select Tab key inserts spaces to insert a series of spaces when you press the Tab key. Otherwise, a tab acts as one space whose length is equal to Tab size .
	Select Tab key applies smart indenting to automatically indent lines according to smart indenting settings when you position the cursor in a line or select a group of lines and then press the Tab key. If you select this setting, you cannot insert tabs within a line.

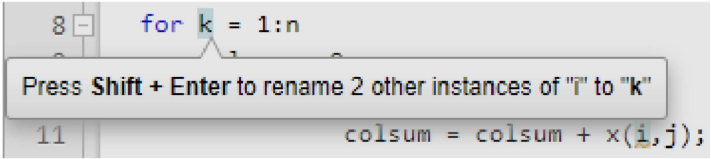
Option	Usage
Smart indenting	Select Smart indenting formats entire document to indent the entire document when using smart indenting in the Editor and Live Editor. Clear this option to indent only the current line or selection.
	Select Add whitespace to empty lines to indent empty lines when using smart indenting in the Editor and Live Editor by adding white space to those lines. Clear this setting to indent only lines that are not empty.
	Select Remove automatically inserted whitespace while typing to remove white space added by smart indenting while typing in the Editor and Live Editor. Clear this setting to leave added white space as is.

Editor/Debugger MATLAB Language Settings

You can specify how code and comments appear in MATLAB code files open in the Editor and Live Editor.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > MATLAB Language**, and then adjust setting options as described in this table.

*Before R2025a: MATLAB Language settings are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Language**.*

Setting	Usage
Syntax highlighting	Select Enable syntax highlighting to have the Editor and Live Editor use different colors for different language constructs in MATLAB code files. Then, to change the MATLAB syntax highlighting colors, go to MATLAB > Appearance > Colors . For more information, see Syntax Highlighting .
Variable and function renaming	Select Enable automatic variable and function renaming to have MATLAB prompt you to rename all instances of a function or variable in a file when you rename a function or variable.  For details on when MATLAB prompts you, see Automatically Rename All Variables or Functions in a File.
Comment formatting	In the Maximum column width field, enter the maximum number of characters you want to allow in a line of comments, and then select where you want counting to begin. Consider selecting: Start from beginning of line when the absolute width of the comments is important. For example, set 75 columns from the start of the line to match the width

Setting	Usage
	that fits on a printed page when you use the default font for the Editor. • Start from beginning of comment when comments are indented, and you want each block of comments to have a consistent indent and width. Select Wrap comments automatically while typing to automatically wrap comments at the Maximum column width value when you type comments in an Editor or Live Editor document. If you clear this option, you can still wrap comments manually, as described in Add Comments to Code.
Indenting	Select Apply smart indenting while typing to automatically: • Indent the body of loops within the start and end of the loop statement. • Align subsequent lines with lines you indent using tabs or spaces. • Indent functions as specified with the Function indenting format option. You also can manually apply smart indenting after you type the code. For more information, see Indent Code. Select an option from Function indenting format to specify how functions indent in the Editor and Live Editor, as follows: • Classic — The Editor and Live Editor align the function code with the function declaration. <pre data-bbox="852 1203 1489 1411">function classic_one disp('Main function code') function classic_two disp('Nested function code') end end</pre> • Indent nested functions — The Editor and Live Editor indent the function code within a nested function. <pre data-bbox="852 1501 1489 1709">function nested_one disp('Main function code') function nested_two disp('Nested function code') end end</pre> • Indent all functions — The Editor and Live Editor indent the function code for both main and nested functions.

Setting	Usage
	<pre>function all_one disp('Main function code') function all_two disp('Nested function code') end end</pre>
File extensions	Add one or more file extensions to associate with the MATLAB Language settings.

Editor/Debugger Other Languages Settings

You can specify how languages other than MATLAB appear in the Editor and Live Editor. MATLAB applies language settings based on the file extension of the file that is open.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **Editor/Debugger > Other Languages > Language**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

Not all settings are available for all languages.

*Before R2025a: Other Language settings are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Language**.*

Setting	Usage
Syntax highlighting	Select Enable syntax highlighting to have the Editor and Live Editor use different colors for different language constructs. Then, adjust the colors you want to use for each language element.
Indenting	Select Apply smart indenting while typing to automatically: • Indent the body of loops within the start and end of the loop statement. • Align subsequent lines with lines you indent using tabs or spaces. • Indent functions as specified with the Function indenting format option. You also can manually apply smart indenting after you type the code. For more information, see Indent Code.
File extensions	Add one or more file extensions to associate with the Language . The settings you specify for that language apply to all files with the listed extensions.

Editor/Debugger Saving Settings

You can specify if and when MATLAB saves files automatically. You also can specify if, when, and how you want MATLAB to automatically back up files that are open in the Editor. Settings related to backing up files are not available in MATLAB Online.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Saving**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

*Before R2025a: Backup settings are located under **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Backup Files**.*

Setting	Usage
Autosave options	Select Save files periodically to have MATLAB periodically save the files you are currently editing.
	In the Every: n minutes field, specify how often you want MATLAB to save the files you are editing. By default, MATLAB saves files every 1 minute.
	Select Save changes upon clicking away from a file if you want the Editor and Live Editor to automatically save changes to a file when you click away from the file. For the changes to be automatically saved upon clicking away, you must have already saved the file at least once.
Output save options	Select Save output to file to save output to your live scripts saved using the plain text Live Code file format (.m). Clear Save output to file to disable saving output.
Backup options	Select Automatically create backup files while working in the MATLAB Editor to have MATLAB automatically save a copy of the files you are currently editing. For more information about automatically creating backup copies of modified files in the Editor, see Save and Back Up Code .
	Save the backup every: n minutes specifies how often you want MATLAB to save a copy of the file you are editing. By default, MATLAB saves a backup copy every 5 minutes.
	Save untitled files saves a copy of new, untitled, files to untitled.asv. When there is more than one untitled file, each additional file is saved to untitledn.asv (where n is an integer value).
	Automatically delete backup files when the Editor closes directs MATLAB to delete the backup file when you close the source file in the Editor. To ensure clear and current backup-to-file relationships if you disable this option, when you rename or remove a file, consider deleting or renaming the corresponding backup file.

Setting	Usage
Backup file name	Select the naming convention that you want MATLAB to use for backup files. For example: - If you specify Replace extension with: asv, the backup file for filename.m is filename.asv - If you specify Append file name with: ~, the backup file for filename.m is filename.m~
Backup location	Source file directories specifies that you want backup files stored in the same folder as the files being edited. Single directory specifies that you want autosave files stored in a single folder. Specify the full path to that folder and be sure you have write permissions for it. If you edit a file in a read-only folder and the back up Location is Source file directories, then the Editor does not create a backup copy of the file.

Editor/Debugger Spelling Settings

Since R2026a

You can turn spell checking on or off by default and change what text to spell check.

On the **Home** tab, in the **Environment** section, click  **Settings**. Select **MATLAB > Editor/Debugger > Spelling**, and then adjust the settings as described in this table.

Setting	Usage
Check spelling	Select an option to turn spell checking on or off: - Auto — Spell checking is on by default for all files. If a file contains many unrecognized words, such as when not written in US English, MATLAB automatically turns spell checking off for that file. - On — Spell checking is always on for all files. - Off — Spell checking is off for all files.
Where to check spelling	Select Monospaced in text to check for spelling issues in monospaced text.
	Select Comments in code to check for spelling issues in code comments.
	Select Strings in code to check for spelling issues in strings.

See Also

Topics

[Code Analyzer Settings](#)